# Elastic Day Dubai 2026

**Date:** 15 January 2026
**Location:** Kempinski The Boulevard Dubai, UAE

## My Experience

This was a highly enlightening experience which helped me to gain a greater understanding of the way in which artificial intelligence is changing businesses and industries at the present time. Since I have an interest in technology and innovation, I looked forward to hearing directly from industry leaders and experts who are currently influencing the future of AI.

The audience included IT professionals, architects, cybersecurity experts, business leaders, and students all of whom had a shared interest in emerging technologies. It became clear to me during the keynote presentations that AI is not any longer just a distant idea but a technology which organisations are currently putting into practice in order to deal with real-world problems.

## Key Learnings

- **Transition from Generative AI to Agentic AI:** Although generative AI is concerned with producing content and reacting to prompts, agentic AI is intended to make decisions, take actions, and carry out tasks with more autonomy. This development brings about exciting possibilities but also poses new challenges in the areas of security, governance, and trust.

- **Data forms the basis of AI:** Many of the sessions stressed that for AI to be successful it is necessary to have high-quality, accessible, and well-organized data and even the most advanced AI models will not be able to produce meaningful results if the appropriate data infrastructure is not in place.

- **Having good observability enhances organizational performance:** The presentation given by e& showed how unified observability can help companies to monitor their systems more effectively, detect problems more quickly, and enhance customer experiences. This proved to me that having a clear view of operations is essential if reliable digital services are to be maintained.

- **Cybersecurity has to keep up with developments in AI:** With the increasing capabilities of AI, cyber threats are also becoming more sophisticated AND to protect the sensitive information? organizations have to constantly adjust their security strategies and make use of the new AI technologies.

- **The business value is more important than the hype:** A important lesson is that achieving successful AI adoption has nothing to do with keeping up with trends, rather organizations should concentrate on practical applications which solve real problems and generate measurable value for customers and stakeholders.

## Speakers

The speakers brought diverse perspectives and valuable industry experience to the event and hearing a different story and explanation perspective from each speaker was a pretty good way to understand things collectively.

- **Oliver Oursin (VP, Growth and Strategy):** His discussion highlighted the importance of scalable and secure AI adoption.
- **Mandy Andress (CISO):** She explored the risks and opportunities associated with moving from generative to agentic AI and to me her session helped me understand how AI is changing the cybersecurity landscape and why responsible implementation is critical.
- **Eleftherios Kreouzis (Senior Manager, Customer Assurance, e&):** His presentation offered practical insights into how **observability transformed operational performance and enhanced customer experiences** and the real-world examples he stated made the concepts much more easier to understand.
- **Camille Corti-Georgiou (Senior Manager, Customer Architecture):** Camille explained how data meshing supports the next generation of agentic AI in observability and also demonstrated the importance of distributed data architectures in enabling intelligent automation.
- **Aleksander Kolev (Senior Manager, Value Engineering):** He focused on creating meaningful business outcomes through AI where he emphasized that organizations should prioritize measurable impact over technological hype.

## Inspiration and Future Ideas

A part of the event that I will always remember was listening to **customer success stories** and **practical examples** instead of just having some theoretical talks. It was clear to me from seeing how companies are applying observability/search and security solutions to their operations that technology can have a direct effect on business performance and on customer experiences. The networking sessions were likewise useful since they gave attendees the opportunity to meet experts and obtain various views regarding the future of AI.

Before attending the event, I viewed AI primarily as a tool for generating content and automating tasks, but the discussions on agentic AI showed me that future systems will be capable of handling such increasingly complex responsibilities and support decision-making processes.